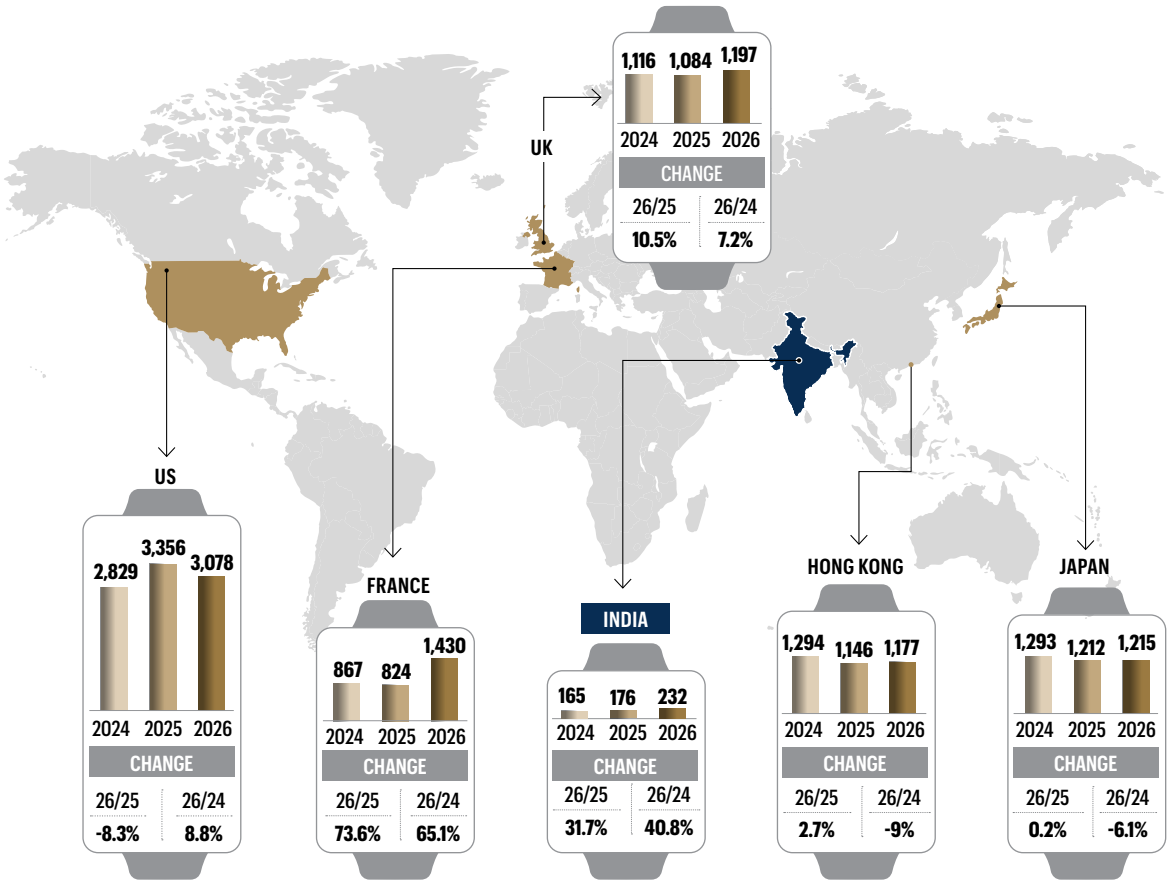
INDIA'S WATCH MOMENT

Strong growth in Swiss watch purchases by Indians

SWISS WATCH EXPORTS BY DESTINATION (MILLION SWISS FRANCS)



DATA FOR JAN-AUG; **SOURCE** FEDERATION OF THE SWISS WATCH INDUSTRY

ing income above ₹1 crore rose 4.7x from 48,417 in AY2014-15 to just under 2,30,000 in AY2023-24.

According to The Wealth Report 2026 by Knight Frank, the number of ultra-high-net-worth individuals (UHNWIs) in India rose 63% from 12,161 to 19,877 between 2021 and 2026, and is expected to rise to 25,217 by 2031. Globally, the number of UHNWIs—people worth more than $30 million—grew from 551,435 to 713,626. In a study this April, Visa Consulting & Analytics found that three in four affluent consumers made at least one high-end purchase every quarter, while one in four bought something premium every two weeks. No surprise India is out of step with the rest of the world.

"India's luxury market has been growing at 10–12% a year," says Neelesh Hundekari, a senior partner at Kearney. "Some of that is inflation pushed up by weaker rupee and dearer gold. The bigger driver is new buyers," he says. "Trading up is happening from premium to luxury. Within luxury, it might be happening in pockets."

LUXURY CARS RISING

On the morning Santosh Iyer sat down for a chat, he had already seen the evidence on his phone. Content creator and entrepreneur Ishan Sharma, 25, had posted a video about the Mercedes-Benz E200 he had just booked in Bengaluru. Sharma said he was